lust, evil thought, and ignorance, not that of forgiveness, charity, and truth." Many similar passages can be cited from Hinduism—and from medieval Christian saints also. But those who do not believe in theism as the highest state of man's existence and, on the contrary, believe in an eternal, experienceless state of existence, are certainly entitled to advocate man's rising above all passions, both good and evil, because they have a different philosophy or ideal of life than that of communion with God. The suppression of passions is not unknown to Christianity either.

The important question is whether Zaehner is comparing Christianity with Hinduism as a religion or with agnostic and atheistic schools of thought in India. If the former, all his conclusions are wrong, and, if the latter, why? In many of his charges against Hinduism, Zaehner forgets that they are equally true of Christianity also. For instance, such teachings as that of "two worlds," and of the separation of the "eternal from the perishable," etc., are by no means exclusive to Hinduism.

The Hindu doctrine of the transmigration of souls is also not as Zaehner understands it. The transmigration of souls follows logically from the undying characteristic of the soul itself which cannot be disembodied unless the soul achieves its set task of the highest ideal of life. A man cannot be denied his apparatus of body and mind through which alone he can accomplish those desires and ambitions of perfection which cannot be achieved in one single span of life. This is not to defend or minimize the difficulties that there are in this or any alternate religious doctrine. The point here is simply to have them properly understood as propounded by their authors.

What, according to Zaehner, is the greatest weakness of Hinduism is perhaps its greatest strength, namely, its lack of revelation.[4] In fact, it is so difficult to understand why he calls it a weakness when he himself has once accepted Hinduism as a non-revelatory religion. Is it because a particular kind of historical revelation is all that is meant be revelation? After all, there can be only three situations with regard to revelation and Hinduism: (1) that Hinduism is not revelatory in which case you cannot judge it by any revelatory standards; (2) that Hindus, too, claim to be revelationists but have an altogether different meaning of revelation, in as much as any perception of eternal truth anywhere by any persons may be called revelation; (3) that Hindus believe in revelation in the same exclusive sense in which the Christians do, and therefore their religion, too, should be judged by the Christian standards of revelation. Actually, the first and second positions alone are